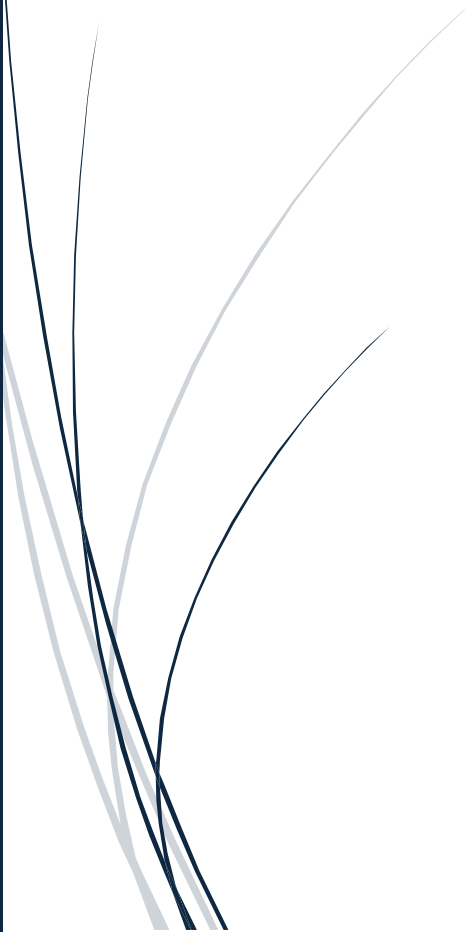




9/1/2026

WEDE5020

POE PART 1 FORMATIVE 1



Rapelang Asher Dimaza
ST10246116

Table of Contents

Organisation Overview	2
Name: Upper Life Apparel	2
Website Goals and Objectives	3
Current Website Analysis	7
Proposed Website Features and Functionality.....	9
Design and User Experience	15
Technical Requirements	19
Timeline and Milestones.....	22
Budget.....	24
Organisation Overview	25
Name: FreshFold Laundry	25
2. Website Goals and Objectives	26
3. Current Website Analysis	30
4. Proposed Website Features and Functionality	32
5. Design and User Experience	37
6. Technical Requirements	40
7. Project Timeline and Milestones.....	43
8. Budget	44
Reference List.....	46

Organisation Overview

Name: Upper Life Apparel

Brief History of Upper Life Apparel

Upper Life Apparel is a clothing brand that was created from a personal experience during high school. The idea started when I noticed the pressure among learners to wear expensive and well-known clothing brands in order to fit in with their peers. Many learners wanted to dress well and feel confident, but the high prices of popular brands made it difficult for everyone to afford them. Rather than allowing expensive clothing to become a barrier to fitting in, I decided to create Upper Life Apparel as an affordable alternative. The initial target audience was my friends and other learners at my high school who experienced the same challenges. The aim was to provide stylish and affordable clothing that allowed young people to express themselves, feel confident and be part of their social groups without having to spend large amounts of money on expensive brands.

As the brand gained recognition, its target audience gradually expanded beyond my high school friends. My friends outside of school also became interested in the clothing, and eventually people within my community who knew me began showing interest and supporting the brand. This growth demonstrated that the need for affordable and stylish clothing was not limited to my school environment but was shared by a wider group of people.

Upper Life Apparel therefore grew from a small idea created for a group of high school friends into a brand with the potential to reach a broader community. Its foundation remains centred on affordability, confidence, self-expression and belonging. The brand aims to show that people should not have to wear expensive labels to look good, feel confident or fit in.

The journey of Upper Life Apparel reflects how a personal problem can develop into a business opportunity. What began as an attempt to provide an affordable option for myself and my school friends gradually attracted friends outside school and members of the wider community. This growing interest encouraged the development of Upper Life Apparel into a clothing brand that seeks to make fashion more accessible while creating a sense of identity and belonging for its customers.

Mission Statement

My mission is to build Upper Life Apparel into an affordable and relatable clothing brand that empowers young people to express themselves, feel confident and fit in without feeling pressured to spend money on expensive brands. I aim to create quality clothing that reflects the creativity, individuality and ambition of young people while making fashion accessible to a wider community.

Vision Statement

My vision is to grow Upper Life Apparel from a clothing brand that started among high school friends into a recognised youth-focused brand that connects young people across different communities. I envision a brand that represents confidence, ambition, self-expression and belonging, while inspiring other young individuals to turn their ideas and personal experiences into meaningful businesses.

Website Goals and Objectives

The Upper Life Apparel website should not only act as an online clothing store but also serve as a platform for brand awareness, customer engagement and national growth. This is especially important because South Africa's online retail market is expanding, with online retail sales projected to exceed R250 000 in 2025. Clothing is also one of the major categories purchased online by South African consumers.

Specific Goals for the Upper Life Apparel Website

Goal 1: Build a strong online presence

The first goal is to establish the Upper Life Apparel website as the central online home for the brand. The website should showcase the brand's history, mission, vision, clothing collections and the lifestyle associated with Upper Life.

Target:

- Launch a professional, mobile-friendly website.
- Reach at least 1,000 unique website visitors within the first six months.
- Build an online customer database through newsletter or account registrations.
- Increase website traffic by 20% every quarter.

Goal 2: Expand beyond the original local audience

Upper Life Apparel originally grew from friends in high school to friends outside school and people who knew the brand within the community. The next goal is to use the website and social media to expand the customer base beyond the local community.

Target:

Within the first 12–24 months, Upper Life Apparel should aim to attract customers from at least three additional South African provinces outside its original customer base.

The website can support this expansion by offering online ordering, nationwide delivery information, customer reviews and content that showcases customers from different parts of South Africa.

Goal 3: Use celebrity styling to increase national recognition

One of the major growth strategies for Upper Life Apparel should be to style South African celebrities, musicians, influencers and other public figures.

The objective is not simply to have celebrities wear the clothing, but to use these collaborations to introduce the brand to audiences in provinces and communities where Upper Life Apparel is not yet well known.

Target:

- Style the first recognised public figure within 12 months.
- Secure 3–5 celebrity/influencer styling opportunities within two years.
- Create dedicated website and social media content around each collaboration.
- Track the increase in website traffic, followers and sales after every celebrity campaign.

This strategy can be particularly valuable because South African consumers are highly influenced by digital and social media when shopping; DHL's South Africa research found that 83% use social media for shopping inspiration and 73% have purchased through social media.

Goal 4: Become a recognised South African youth clothing brand

The long-term national goal is for Upper Life Apparel to become recognised beyond its original community and establish itself as a youth-focused South African clothing brand.

Target:

Within 3–5 years, aim to:

- Have customers in all nine South African provinces.
- Build a strong online following.
- Collaborate with South African celebrities and influencers.
- Develop collections that represent the identity and creativity of young South Africans.
- Generate a significant percentage of sales through the website.

Goal 5: Expand internationally

Once Upper Life Apparel has established a strong South African customer base, the next stage will be international expansion.

The website should eventually support customers outside South Africa by providing international shipping information, appropriate payment options and a clear international ordering process.

Target:

Within 5–7 years, Upper Life Apparel should aim to begin selling to selected international markets, initially targeting countries where there is potential interest in South African youth culture and fashion.

The ultimate vision is for Upper Life Apparel to become a South African-born clothing brand with an international customer base.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

Key performance indicators are measurable values that show whether a business is progressing towards its objectives. For an online clothing business, useful KPIs include website traffic, conversion rate, average order value, customer acquisition cost, repeat purchases and customer retention.

Upper Life Apparel should avoid focusing only on followers and likes, because these numbers do not necessarily mean that the business is making sales. A more effective approach is to connect each KPI to a specific business goal.

The five most important KPIs for the website would therefore be:

- Website traffic – measures how many people are visiting the Upper Life website.
- Conversion rate – measures how many website visitors actually purchase clothing.
- Online revenue – measures the financial performance of the website.
- Repeat purchase rate – measures whether customers return to purchase again.
- Customer acquisition cost (CAC) – measures how much Upper Life spends to gain each new customer.

Overall Website Success

The ultimate measure of success will be whether the Upper Life Apparel website helps transform the brand from a clothing business that originally started among high school friends and the local community into a recognised South African youth fashion brand. The website should support this journey by attracting new customers, converting visitors into buyers, encouraging existing customers to return, and creating opportunities for celebrity collaborations.

The long-term growth path can therefore be represented as:

1. High School Friends
2. Local Community
3. Friends and Wider Community
4. Multiple South African Provinces
5. All 9 Provinces
6. South African Celebrities
7. National Brand Recognition
8. International Markets

This creates a clear progression from the brand's original roots to its long-term vision.

Current Website Analysis

Although there is no website to evaluate, Upper Life Apparel itself already has several strengths that the new website should build upon:

Strong personal origin – The brand started from a real problem experienced by young people in high school.

Existing word-of-mouth awareness – The audience has already grown from school friends to people outside school and members of the community.

Relatable target market – The brand addresses affordability, confidence, self-expression and the desire to fit in without purchasing expensive labels.

Growth potential – The existing network provides a foundation for expanding into other provinces.

Clear long-term vision – The brand aims to work with celebrities, expand nationally and eventually enter international markets.

These strengths should be incorporated into the website so that the website does not simply function as an online shop but also communicates the identity and story of Upper Life Apparel.

Weaknesses and Areas for Improvement

The biggest weakness at present is the absence of a central digital platform. A potential customer who discovers Upper Life Apparel through word of mouth or social media may not have an immediate place to learn about the brand, explore all available products and complete a purchase.

The proposed website should therefore address the following areas:

Improve accessibility to products

Customers should be able to view clothing collections, prices, sizes, colours and availability in one place.

Simplify purchasing

The website should provide a clear shopping cart and checkout process, allowing customers to purchase products without relying on direct messages or personal arrangements.

Strengthen brand identity

The About Us section should communicate how Upper Life Apparel started in high school and how it developed into a wider community brand.

Support national expansion

The website should make it possible to accept orders from customers across all nine South African provinces. This supports the long-term goal of growing beyond the original local customer base.

Prepare for celebrity marketing

A dedicated section should showcase celebrities, influencers and public figures wearing Upper Life Apparel. This can help demonstrate the brand's growth and create social proof.

Improve customer communication

Contact forms, FAQs, social media integration and customer accounts can provide customers with easier ways to communicate with the brand.

Make the website user-friendly

The proposed website should use clear navigation, readable content, consistent layouts and accessible controls. Research into e-commerce usability emphasises clarity, ease of navigation and reducing unnecessary friction in the customer journey.

Consider accessibility

The website should be designed so that as many people as possible can use it, including people with disabilities. This includes appropriate text contrast, keyboard navigation, descriptive alternative text for product images and clear form labels.

Overall Analysis

The absence of an existing website should therefore be viewed as a business opportunity rather than simply a weakness. Upper Life Apparel already has a foundation based on personal connections, community awareness and a relatable brand story. The proposed website can transform this existing awareness into a more structured digital presence.

The website should ultimately help Upper Life Apparel

Proposed Website Features and Functionality

The Upper Life Apparel website should be designed as an **online clothing store and brand platform** that allows customers to learn about the brand, browse products, make purchases and communicate with the business. Since the brand aims to grow from its local community to other South African provinces and eventually international markets, the website should be simple, professional, mobile-friendly and easy to navigate.

Homepage

The homepage will be the first page visitors see and should immediately communicate the **identity, style and purpose of Upper Life Apparel**.

Essential features:

- Upper Life Apparel logo and brand name.
- Navigation menu.
- Attractive banner displaying current clothing or campaigns.
- Short introduction to the brand.
- Featured/new products.
- Promotional offers.
- Call-to-action buttons such as **“Shop Now”** and **“Explore the Collection.”**
- Links to social media platforms.
- Customer reviews or testimonials.
- Information about delivery and promotions.

Desired functionality:

- Users can quickly navigate to different sections of the website.
- Promotional banners can be updated when new collections are launched.
- Featured products can link directly to their product pages.
- The website should be responsive on phones, tablets and computers.

About Us

The About Us page should tell the **story behind Upper Life Apparel** and help customers connect with the brand.

Essential features:

- History of Upper Life Apparel.
- Explanation of how the brand started in high school.
- The original problem of expensive clothing brands.
- How the target audience grew from high school friends to friends outside school and people within the community.
- Mission statement.
- Vision statement.
- Brand values.
- Future goals, including national and international expansion.

Desired functionality:

- Easy-to-read layout.
- Images showing the brand's journey.
- Links to social media.
- Sections that can be updated as the business grows.

This page is particularly important because Upper Life Apparel is built around a **personal story and the experiences of young people.**

Products / Shop Page

The Products page will be one of the most important parts of the website because it will allow customers to browse and purchase Upper Life Apparel clothing.

Essential features:

- Product images.
- Product names and descriptions.
- Prices.
- Available sizes.
- Available colours.
- Stock availability.
- Product categories, such as T-shirts, hoodies, pants and accessories.

- “New Arrivals” section.
- “Best Sellers” section.

Desired functionality:

- Search products.
- Filter by size, price, category and colour.
- Sort products by price, popularity or newest arrivals.
- Select different sizes and quantities.
- Add products to a shopping cart.
- View product details before purchasing.
- Receive an indication when an item is out of stock.

Product Details Page

Each individual product should have its own page where customers can see detailed information before making a purchase.

Essential features:

- Multiple product photographs.
- Product name.
- Price.
- Description.
- Available sizes and colours.
- Size guide.
- Material information.
- Stock availability.
- Customer reviews.

Desired functionality:

- Zoom into product images.
- Select size and colour.
- Select quantity.
- Add item to cart.
- Add item to a wishlist.
- View recommended or similar products.

Shopping Cart and Checkout

The website should provide a straightforward purchasing process so that customers can purchase products without unnecessary complications.

Essential features:

- Cart containing selected products.
- Product quantities.
- Individual and total prices.
- Delivery costs.
- Estimated total.
- Customer delivery information.
- Order summary.
- Payment section.
- Order confirmation.

Desired functionality:

- Add, remove and update products.
- Automatically calculate totals.
- Apply promotional/discount codes.
- Secure online payment.
- Provide an order confirmation.
- Send an order confirmation to the customer's email.
- Allow customers to track their order.

Contact Us

The Contact page should make it easy for customers to communicate with Upper Life Apparel.

Essential features:

- Contact form.
- Email address.
- Telephone/WhatsApp contact.
- Social media links.
- Business location, if applicable.
- Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs).

Desired functionality:

- Customers can submit enquiries directly through the website.
- Form submissions can be received by the business.
- Customers receive confirmation that their enquiry has been submitted.
- WhatsApp or other communication channels can be accessed directly.

- FAQ information can answer common questions about sizes, orders, delivery and returns.

Customer Account

A customer account can improve the overall shopping experience, particularly as Upper Life Apparel grows.

Essential features:

- Customer registration and login.
- Personal details.
- Saved delivery addresses.
- Order history.
- Wishlist.
- Saved preferences.

Desired functionality:

- Customers can log in securely.
- View previous orders.
- Track current orders.
- Update personal information.
- Save products for later.
- Receive notifications about new collections and promotions.

Celebrity and Influencer Showcase

Since one of Upper Life Apparel's long-term goals is to grow by styling celebrities and influencers, the website should include a section dedicated to collaborations.

Essential features:

- Photos of celebrities wearing Upper Life Apparel.
- Information about collaborations.
- Campaign photographs and videos.
- Links to relevant social media posts.
- "As Seen On" section.

Desired functionality:

- Visitors can view previous collaborations.
- Images can link to the clothing worn by the celebrity.

- Social media content can be embedded or linked.
- New collaborations can easily be added.

This feature can help demonstrate that Upper Life Apparel is moving from a local youth brand towards **national recognition**.

Reviews and Testimonials

Customer feedback can help build trust with new customers.

Essential features:

- Star ratings.
- Written reviews.
- Customer photographs, where permission is provided.
- Testimonials.

Desired functionality:

- Customers can submit reviews after purchasing.
- Products can display their average rating.
- Reviews can be moderated before appearing publicly.

Delivery and Returns

A dedicated page should clearly explain how customers receive their orders and what happens if they need to return an item.

Essential features:

- Delivery areas.
- Delivery fees.
- Estimated delivery times.
- Returns policy.
- Exchange policy.
- Refund information.

Desired functionality:

- Customers can enter their location to determine delivery availability/cost where applicable.
- Customers can access return instructions.
- Order tracking can be linked from the customer's account.

Design and User Experience

The overall design of the Upper Life Apparel website will follow a modern, simple and youthful aesthetic that reflects the personality of the brand. Since Upper Life Apparel was created to provide affordable and fashionable clothing for young people, the website should communicate confidence, self-expression, ambition and belonging. The design should be visually attractive without becoming overcrowded, allowing the clothing and brand identity to remain the main focus.

Colour Palette

The primary colour palette will consist of white and red, supported by dark neutral colours such as black or dark grey for text.

White will be the dominant colour throughout the website. It will create a clean, spacious and professional appearance while making product information easy to read. White space will also prevent the website from appearing too busy and will allow product information, headings and important features to stand out.

Red will be used as the main accent colour. Red is a strong and energetic colour that can represent confidence, passion, ambition and bold self-expression, which are closely connected to the identity of Upper Life Apparel. Rather than covering large sections of the website in red, it should be used strategically for important elements such as:

- "Shop Now" buttons
- "Add to Cart" buttons
- Promotions and special offers
- Important headings or highlights
- Navigation hover effects
- Product badges such as "New" or "Sale"
- Important links and calls to action

Using red selectively will make these elements immediately noticeable while maintaining the clean appearance created by the white background.

The colour combination should therefore communicate that Upper Life Apparel is bold and youthful, but still clean, modern and professional.

Typography

The website should use a modern, simple sans-serif font to support the contemporary identity of the brand. A font such as Montserrat, Poppins or Inter would be suitable because these fonts are clean and easy to read on both desktop and mobile devices.

A consistent typographic hierarchy should be used throughout the website:

- Large, bold headings for major sections such as "New Collection" and "Our Story".
- Medium-weight subheadings for product categories and supporting information.
- Regular-weight body text for descriptions and information.
- Bold text for important information such as prices and promotions.
- Clear button text such as "Shop Now", "View Collection" and "Add to Cart".

The typography should not use too many different fonts or styles because this could make the website look inconsistent. Using one primary font family with different weights and sizes will create a more professional visual identity.

Overall Layout and Design

The website will use a simple grid-based layout with plenty of white space. This will make it easier for users to scan information and find what they are looking for.

The design should avoid unnecessary animations, excessive graphics or complicated menus. Instead, each page should have a clear purpose and follow a consistent structure.

The general design principles will include:

Simplicity – Only necessary information and features should be displayed.

Consistency – Colours, fonts, buttons and navigation should remain consistent across pages.

Visual hierarchy – Important information should be more prominent than secondary information.

White space – Empty space should be used to separate sections and prevent clutter.

Clear calls to action – Users should immediately understand what action they can take.

Responsive design – The website should work effectively on computers, tablets and smartphones.

Product-focused design – Clothing should remain the central focus of the website.

The overall appearance should make Upper Life Apparel feel like a professional clothing brand while maintaining its youthful and relatable origins.

The user experience (UX) is important because the website should make it easy for customers to discover products, understand the brand and complete purchases without unnecessary difficulty.

The navigation system should be simple and consistent on every page.

The main navigation could include:

Home | About Us | Shop | Collections | Contact | Cart

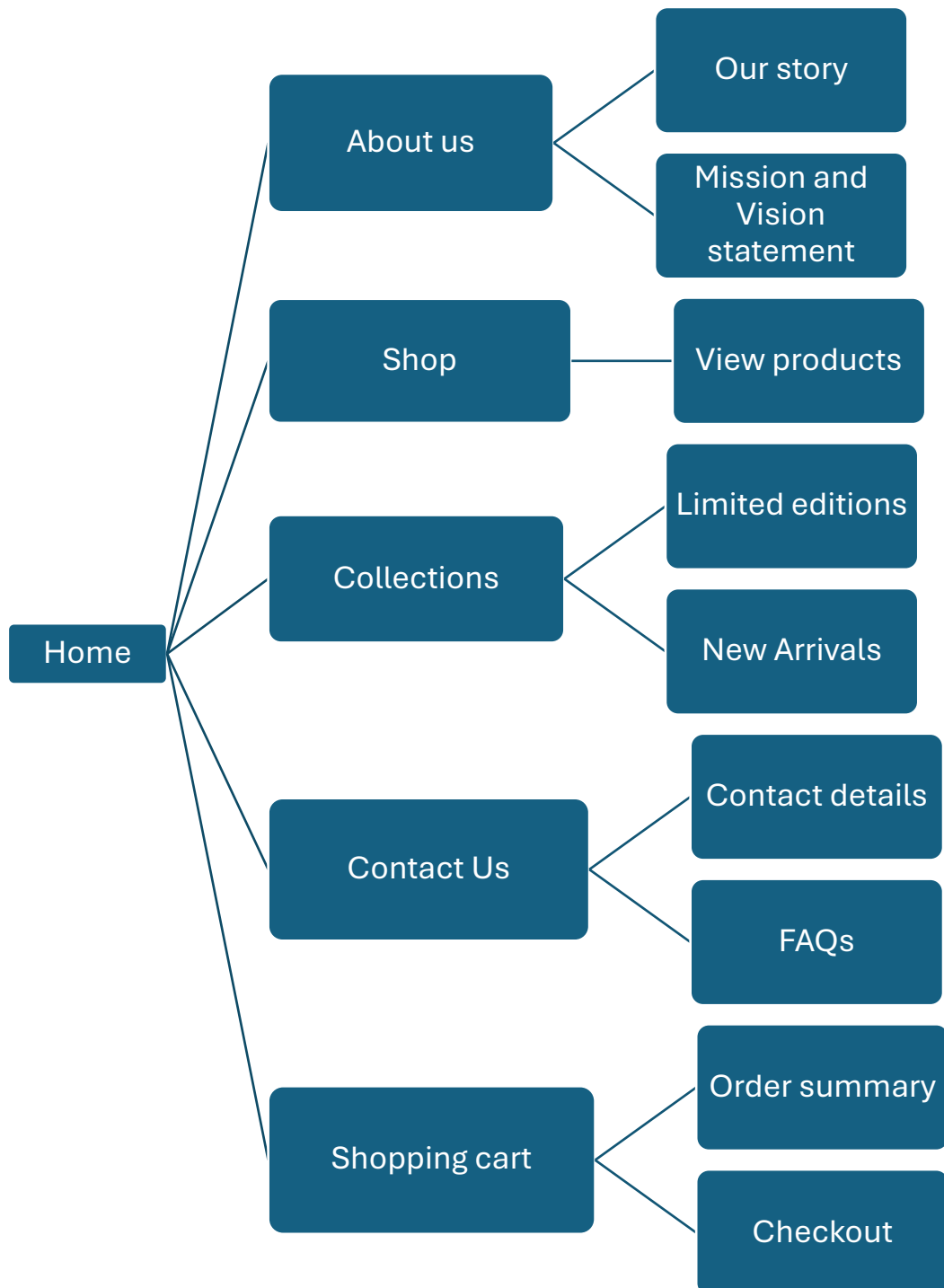
The navigation bar should remain at the top of the page. The Upper Life Apparel logo should appear on the left, while the navigation options can appear across the centre or right side.

A shopping-cart icon should also be clearly visible so that customers can easily access the products they have selected.

On mobile devices, the navigation can be converted into a hamburger menu to save screen space.

The navigation should prevent users from having to search through multiple pages to find basic information such as products, prices, delivery information or contact details.

Low-fidelity wireframe:



Technical Requirements

Hosting and Domain Name Requirements

Domain Name

The website will require a unique domain name that is easy for customers to remember and directly associated with the Upper Life Apparel brand.

A suitable domain could be:

hello.upperlifeapparel.co.za

The **.co.za** domain is appropriate because Upper Life Apparel is a South African clothing brand and the initial target market is South African customers. As the business expands internationally, alternative domains such as .com could also be considered.

The domain name should be:

- Short and easy to remember.
- Closely related to the brand name.
- Easy to spell and type.
- Professional.
- Consistent with the brand's social media presence.

The business would need to register the domain through an accredited domain registrar and renew it periodically.

Web Hosting

The website will also require **web hosting**. Hosting provides the server space needed to store the website's files, product information, images and other data so that customers can access the website through the internet.

For a small clothing business such as Upper Life Apparel, shared hosting or cloud hosting could initially be sufficient. As the number of customers and website visitors increases, the business could move to a more powerful hosting solution.

The hosting service should provide:

- Reliable server availability.
- Sufficient storage for product information and images.
- Adequate bandwidth for website visitors.
- Database support.
- SSL/HTTPS support.
- Regular backups.
- Security features.
- Technical support.
- Ability to scale as the business grows.

Because the website will process customer information and online payments, HTTPS and an SSL/TLS certificate are particularly important for protecting information transferred between customers and the website.

Programming Languages and Frameworks

The Upper Life Apparel website can use several programming languages and frameworks to create the front-end, back-end and database components.

HTML – HyperText Markup Language

HTML will be used to create the basic structure of the website.

It can be used to define:

- Headings
- Paragraphs
- Navigation menus
- Product sections
- Forms
- Buttons
- Links
- Images
- Tables
- Footer sections

For example, HTML would determine the structure of the **Shop, About Us, Collections, Contact Us and Shopping Cart** pages.

CSS – Cascading Style Sheets

CSS will control the visual appearance of the website.

It will be used for:

- Upper Life Apparel's white and red colour palette.
- Font styles and typography.
- Spacing and margins.
- Product grids.
- Navigation bars.
- Buttons.
- Page layouts.
- Responsive design.
- Mobile and tablet layouts.

CSS will therefore help create the **modern, clean and simple aesthetic** planned for Upper Life Apparel.

JavaScript

JavaScript will provide interactivity and dynamic functionality.

It can be used for:

- Product filtering.
- Product searching.
- Shopping-cart updates.
- Quantity controls.
- Form validation.
- Interactive menus.
- Image/product interactions.
- Promotional features.
- Updating order totals.
- Providing feedback when products are added to the cart.

For example, when a customer clicks "**Add to Cart**", JavaScript can update the shopping cart without requiring the entire page to reload.

Timeline and Milestones

Managing the Timeline

The timeline allows approximately 12 weeks for the complete project. Development should not begin before the planning and design stages are sufficiently completed, as this could result in major changes later in the project. Testing is also scheduled before the final submission so that problems can be identified and corrected rather than discovered at the last minute.

The final week should be reserved for proofreading, checking submission requirements and uploading the completed project. A small amount of time should also be kept as a contingency in case technical problems, design changes or unexpected delays occur.

If the subject provides multiple submission dates throughout the semester, each relevant phase can be submitted at its corresponding deadline.

Key Project Milestones

The major milestones for the Upper Life Apparel project will be:

Milestone 1 – Requirements Completed

The target users, business objectives and website requirements have been identified.

Milestone 2 – User-Centred Design Completed

User personas, user goals, user journeys and user experience requirements have been established.

Milestone 3 – Website Structure Completed

The site map and information hierarchy have been developed.

Milestone 4 – Low-Fidelity Wireframes Completed

The basic layouts for the website's main pages have been created.

Milestone 5 – Visual Design Completed

The Upper Life Apparel branding, white and red colour palette, typography and modern layout have been established.

Milestone 6 – Functional Prototype Completed

The main website pages and core functionality have been developed.

Milestone 7 – E-Commerce Features Completed

Product browsing, shopping cart and checkout functionality have been implemented.

Milestone 8 – Testing Completed

The website has been tested for functionality, usability, responsiveness and accessibility.

Milestone 9 – Final Project Completed

All improvements and documentation have been completed and the project is ready for submission.

Managing the Timeline

The timeline allows approximately 12 weeks for the complete project. Development should not begin before the planning and design stages are sufficiently completed, as this could result in major changes later in the project. Testing is also scheduled before the final submission so that problems can be identified and corrected rather than discovered at the last minute.

The final week should be reserved for proofreading, checking submission requirements and uploading the completed project. A small amount of time should also be kept as a contingency in case technical problems, design changes or unexpected delays occur.

If the subject provides multiple submission dates throughout the semester, each relevant phase can be submitted at its corresponding deadline.

Budget

Estimated Upper Life Apparel Website Budget

Cost Item	Estimated Cost
Website planning & requirements	R2,500
UI/UX design and wireframes	R4,000
Website development	R15,000
E-commerce/shop functionality	R8,000
Shopping cart & checkout	R4,000
Payment gateway integration	R2,500
Customer accounts & reviews	R2,500
Product/content setup	R3,000
Testing & mobile optimisation	R2,500
Domain (.co.za) – first year	R150
Hosting – first year	R3,600
SSL/security	R0
Initial SEO setup	R2,000
Estimated development + first-year setup	R49,750

A R50,000 budget is therefore a realistic figure for the first year of a professionally developed Upper Life Apparel e-commerce website. This is within current South African market ranges for e-commerce websites, although a simpler template-based store could be considerably cheaper.

Organisation Overview

Name: FreshFold Laundry

Brief History of FreshFold Laundry

FreshFold Laundry is a small laundry and garment-care business created to provide convenient, affordable and reliable laundry services to people who do not always have enough time or suitable facilities to manage their laundry themselves. The idea was developed after identifying a common problem faced by students, working professionals, families and people living in accommodation without access to washing machines.

Many people have busy schedules and struggle to find enough time to wash, dry, iron and fold their clothes. Students living in residences or rented accommodation may also have limited access to laundry facilities, while working individuals may return home tired after a long day and have little time for household chores. Families with large amounts of laundry may also find it difficult to keep up with their weekly washing.

FreshFold Laundry was established to provide a practical solution to this problem. The business offers customers a convenient way to have their clothes washed, dried, folded and, where required, ironed. Customers can either drop their laundry off at the laundromat or make use of a collection and delivery service.

The initial target market is students, working professionals and households within the local community. The business aims to provide affordable services while maintaining high standards of cleanliness, care and customer service.

As the business grows, FreshFold Laundry intends to expand its customer base beyond the immediate community. The business can achieve this through online bookings, social media marketing, collection and delivery services and partnerships with student accommodation, guesthouses, salons, restaurants and other businesses that require regular laundry services.

The journey of FreshFold Laundry demonstrates how a common everyday problem can be transformed into a small-business opportunity. Instead of customers spending hours managing their laundry, FreshFold Laundry provides a service that allows them to save time and focus on their studies, work, families and other responsibilities.

Mission Statement

My mission is to build FreshFold Laundry into a reliable, affordable and customer-focused laundry service that saves customers time and makes everyday laundry easier. I aim to provide high-quality washing, drying, folding, ironing and collection services while ensuring that customers' clothing and belongings are handled with care.

Vision Statement

My vision is to grow FreshFold Laundry from a small local laundromat into a recognised and trusted laundry service operating across multiple communities. I envision a business that is known for convenience, reliability, affordability and excellent customer service, while creating employment opportunities and using technology to make laundry services easier to access.

2. Website Goals and Objectives

The FreshFold Laundry website should not only provide information about the business but should also make it easier for customers to **book laundry services, request collections and deliveries, view prices, track orders and communicate with the business.**

The website will therefore act as both a **marketing platform and an online service-booking system.**

Goal 1: Establish a Strong Online Presence

The first goal is to establish FreshFold Laundry as a professional and accessible local laundry business.

Target:

- Launch a professional, mobile-friendly website.
- Reach at least **500 unique website visitors within the first six months.**
- Provide customers with clear information about services and prices.
- Increase website traffic by **15% every quarter.**
- Build an online customer database through account registrations and enquiries.

The website will give potential customers a central location where they can learn about FreshFold Laundry instead of relying only on word-of-mouth or social media.

Goal 2: Increase Online Laundry Bookings

One of the main purposes of the website will be to allow customers to arrange laundry services without needing to visit the laundromat or make a phone call.

Target:

Within the first 12 months:

- Achieve at least **100 online service bookings per month**.
- Allow customers to select their preferred service.
- Allow customers to select collection or drop-off.
- Allow customers to choose a preferred date and time.
- Provide confirmation after a booking has been submitted.
- Reduce the amount of manual booking administration.

This will make the service more convenient for customers and reduce the amount of time staff spend recording bookings manually.

Goal 3: Introduce Collection and Delivery Services

FreshFold Laundry should provide customers with the option of having their laundry collected from their home, student accommodation or workplace and returned once it has been cleaned.

Target:

Within 12–24 months:

- Offer collection and delivery within the initial service area.
- Receive at least **50 collection/delivery orders per month**.
- Expand the delivery area as demand increases.
- Provide customers with order status updates.
- Establish partnerships with student residences and local businesses.

This service will make FreshFold Laundry more convenient for customers who do not have enough time to visit the laundromat.

Goal 4: Build Customer Loyalty

The business should encourage customers to use FreshFold Laundry regularly rather than only once.

Target:

Within two years:

- Develop a customer loyalty programme.
- Achieve a repeat-customer rate of at least **40%**.
- Offer promotions to regular customers.
- Provide loyalty discounts after a certain number of orders.
- Collect customer feedback and use it to improve services.

For example, customers could receive points each time they use FreshFold Laundry and eventually exchange their points for discounts.

Goal 5: Expand the Business

The long-term goal is to expand FreshFold Laundry beyond its original local customer base.

Target:

Within 3–5 years:

- Establish additional service areas.
- Increase the number of collection and delivery vehicles.
- Develop partnerships with student accommodation facilities.
- Provide commercial laundry services to small businesses.
- Increase the number of monthly customers.
- Consider opening additional laundromat branches.

Potential business customers could include:

- Student residences

- Guesthouses
- Airbnb hosts
- Restaurants
- Salons
- Spas
- Small hotels
- Gyms
- Healthcare-related businesses where appropriate laundry-handling requirements can be met

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

FreshFold Laundry should use measurable KPIs to determine whether the website and business are achieving their objectives.

The five most important KPIs would be:

- **Website traffic** – measures the number of people visiting the website.
- **Online booking rate** – measures how many website visitors make a laundry booking.
- **Monthly revenue** – measures the financial performance of the business.
- **Repeat customer rate** – measures how many customers return to use the service.
- **Customer satisfaction** – measures how satisfied customers are with the laundry service.

Additional KPIs could include:

- Number of collection and delivery orders.
- Average order value.
- Number of new customers.
- Number of customer enquiries.
- Booking cancellation rate.
- Average turnaround time.

- Number of customer complaints.
- Social media engagement.

Overall Website Success

The ultimate measure of success will be whether the FreshFold Laundry website helps transform the business from a small local laundromat into a **recognised and convenient laundry service**.

The website should:

Attract customers → Explain services → Accept bookings → Process orders → Provide updates → Encourage repeat customers

The long-term growth path can therefore be represented as:

1. Local Customers
2. Students and Working Professionals
3. Wider Community
4. Collection and Delivery
5. Local Business Partnerships
6. Multiple Service Areas
7. Additional Branches
8. Recognised Laundry Brand

3. Current Website Analysis

Although FreshFold Laundry does not currently have a website, the business concept already has several strengths that the proposed website can build upon.

Existing Strengths

Clear customer need

Laundry is an essential household task, creating a consistent need for washing, drying, ironing and folding services.

Convenience

The business saves customers time by handling their laundry for them.

Wide target market

The service can appeal to students, working professionals, families and small businesses.

Potential for recurring customers

Laundry is a regular requirement, meaning satisfied customers can return weekly or monthly.

Collection and delivery potential

The business can increase convenience by collecting laundry from customers and returning it after completion.

Growth potential

The business can expand into other communities and eventually establish additional branches.

Weaknesses and Areas for Improvement

The biggest weakness is the absence of a central digital platform.

Customers may currently need to contact the business manually to ask about:

- Prices
- Services
- Operating hours
- Availability
- Collection areas
- Delivery fees
- Booking arrangements

The website should therefore address the following areas.

Improve Access to Information

Customers should be able to view all laundry services, prices, operating hours and policies in one place.

Simplify Bookings

Customers should be able to book a service online instead of relying entirely on telephone calls or messages.

Improve Order Management

The website should help the business keep track of customer orders, collection times, service requirements and order status.

Support Collection and Delivery

Customers should be able to provide their address and select a collection or delivery option.

Improve Customer Communication

The website should provide contact forms, FAQs, WhatsApp integration and order notifications.

Improve Customer Trust

The website can display:

- Customer reviews
- Service information
- Pricing
- Business information
- Hygiene and garment-care practices
- Terms and conditions

Improve Business Administration

Online bookings can reduce the amount of paperwork and manual administration required by staff.

4. Proposed Website Features and Functionality

The FreshFold Laundry website should be designed as a **laundry service information, booking and customer-management platform**.

Homepage

The homepage should immediately communicate what FreshFold Laundry offers.

Essential features:

- FreshFold Laundry logo.
- Navigation menu.

- Short introduction.
- Main service information.
- "Book a Laundry Service" button.
- "Request Collection" button.
- Featured services.
- Pricing highlights.
- Customer testimonials.
- Operating hours.
- Contact information.
- Social media links.

Desired functionality:

- Users can quickly access the booking system.
- Service sections link to detailed service pages.
- Promotions can be updated.
- Website is responsive on mobile devices.

About Us

The About Us page should explain the story behind FreshFold Laundry.

Essential features:

- Business history.
- Reason the business was established.
- Mission statement.
- Vision statement.
- Business values.
- Target customers.
- Future goals.
- Commitment to customer service.

Values could include:

Reliability | Convenience | Affordability | Cleanliness | Customer Care | Efficiency

Services

The Services page should allow customers to understand exactly what FreshFold Laundry offers.

Possible services include:

- Wash and Dry
- Wash, Dry and Fold
- Ironing
- Dry-cleaning partnerships, if available
- Blanket and duvet cleaning
- Bedding laundry
- Curtain cleaning
- Collection and Delivery
- Commercial Laundry Services

Each service should display:

- Service name
- Description
- Price
- Estimated turnaround time
- Requirements
- Booking button

Online Booking

The online booking page will be one of the most important parts of the website.

Customers should be able to enter:

- Full name
- Phone number

- Email address
- Service required
- Approximate laundry quantity
- Collection or drop-off
- Collection address
- Preferred date
- Preferred time
- Special instructions
- Preferred payment method

The customer should then receive a booking confirmation.

Shopping/Service Cart

Instead of a traditional shopping cart used by a clothing business, FreshFold Laundry can use a **Service Cart**.

Order Tracking

Customers should be able to see the progress of their laundry.

A simple status system could be:

Booking Confirmed → Laundry Collected → Washing → Drying → Folding/Ironing → Ready → Out for Delivery → Completed

This can reduce the number of customers contacting the business to ask about the status of their laundry.

Contact Us

The Contact Us page should include:

- Contact form.
- Telephone number.
- WhatsApp.
- Email address.
- Physical address.
- Operating hours.
- Social media.
- Location/map.
- FAQs.

The contact form could include:

Name → Email → Subject → Message → Send

Customer Reviews

Customers should be able to provide feedback about their experience.

The section could include:

- Star rating.
- Written review.
- Customer name.
- Date of review.
- Service used.

Reviews can help new customers feel more confident about using FreshFold Laundry.

Delivery and Collection

A dedicated page should explain:

- Collection areas.
- Delivery areas.

- Collection times.
- Delivery times.
- Delivery fees.
- Minimum order requirements.
- What happens if the customer is unavailable.
- Order tracking.
- Contact information.

Frequently Asked Questions

The FAQ page could answer questions such as:

- How long does laundry take?
- How much does the service cost?
- Do you collect and deliver?
- What areas do you cover?
- How should I prepare my laundry?
- What happens if clothing is damaged?
- What happens if an item is missing?
- Do you wash delicate clothing?
- What payment methods do you accept?
- Can I cancel my booking?

5. Design and User Experience

The FreshFold Laundry website should have a **clean, fresh, modern and welcoming aesthetic**. The design should communicate cleanliness, reliability and convenience.

Colour Palette

A suitable colour palette would use:

White as the primary background colour.

Blue or teal as the main brand colour.

Dark grey for text.

Light blue/grey as supporting colours.

White represents cleanliness and simplicity, while blue or teal can communicate trust, freshness and professionalism.

The main colour should be used for:

- Buttons
- Navigation highlights
- Headings
- Booking actions
- Important information
- Icons

The colour palette should remain consistent throughout the website.

Typography

The website should use a modern sans-serif font such as:

- Poppins
- Montserrat
- Inter
- Open Sans

Large bold headings can be used for important sections, while regular-weight text should be used for descriptions and instructions.

Typography should be:

- Clear
- Readable
- Consistent
- Easy to understand
- Suitable for mobile devices

Overall Layout

The website should use a **simple, clean and organised layout**.

The homepage could follow this hierarchy:

Logo/Navigation → Main Message → Book Now → Services → How It Works → Pricing → Reviews → Contact → Footer

The design should avoid overcrowding the page with unnecessary information.

User Experience Considerations

The website should make the laundry process as easy as possible.

The ideal customer journey would be:

Visit Website → View Services → Check Price → Book Service → Select Collection/Drop-off → Confirm Booking → Laundry Processed → Receive Update → Collect/Delivery → Review Service

Navigation

The navigation menu could include:

Home | About Us | Services | Pricing | Book Now | Track Order | Contact

Mobile Experience

The website should be responsive because customers may use smartphones to make bookings.

Mobile users should be able to:

- Book a service.
- Contact the business.
- Check prices.

- Track orders.
- Request collection.
- View operating hours.

6. Technical Requirements

Domain Name

A suitable domain name for the business could be:

www.freshfoldlaundry.co.za

The .co.za domain is appropriate because FreshFold Laundry would initially target customers in South Africa.

The domain should be:

- Easy to remember.
- Easy to spell.
- Related to the business name.
- Professional.
- Consistent with social media branding.

The domain would need to be registered through an appropriate domain registrar and renewed periodically.

Web Hosting

FreshFold Laundry will require web hosting to store the website and make it accessible online.

A small business could initially use **shared hosting or cloud hosting**, with the option to upgrade as the number of customers increases.

The hosting provider should offer:

- Reliable uptime.
- Sufficient storage.

- Database support.
- SSL/HTTPS.
- Regular backups.
- Security features.
- Technical support.
- Scalability.

HTTPS is particularly important because customers will provide personal information, addresses and potentially payment information through the website.

Programming Languages and Frameworks

HTML

HTML5 will be used to create the structure of the website.

It will define:

- Headings
- Paragraphs
- Navigation
- Forms
- Buttons
- Service sections
- Tables
- Links
- Footer

CSS

CSS3 will control the appearance and layout.

It will be used for:

- Colours.
- Typography.

- Navigation.
- Buttons.
- Forms.
- Service cards.
- Responsive layouts.
- Spacing.
- Mobile design.

JavaScript

JavaScript will provide interactive functionality.

It can be used for:

- Online booking forms.
- Service selection.
- Price calculations.
- Booking validation.
- Order tracking.
- Customer notifications.
- Interactive menus.
- Form validation.
- Updating the service cart.

For example, when a customer selects **Wash & Fold – 5 kg**, JavaScript can automatically calculate the estimated price.

7. Project Timeline and Milestones

A realistic project can be completed over approximately **12 weeks**.

Key Milestones

Milestone 1 – Requirements Completed

The target customers, business objectives and website requirements have been identified.

Milestone 2 – User-Centred Design Completed

Customer needs, goals and expectations have been established.

Milestone 3 – Website Structure Completed

The sitemap, navigation and information hierarchy have been developed.

Milestone 4 – Low-Fidelity Wireframes Completed

The basic structure of the website pages has been established.

Milestone 5 – Visual Design Completed

The FreshFold Laundry branding, colour palette, typography and layout have been finalised.

Milestone 6 – Functional Website Completed

The main website pages have been developed.

Milestone 7 – Online Booking Completed

Customers can select services and submit laundry bookings.

Milestone 8 – Testing Completed

The website has been tested for functionality, usability, responsiveness and accessibility.

Milestone 9 – Final Submission

The website and supporting documentation have been completed and submitted.

Overall Business Concept

FreshFold Laundry provides a strong small-business concept for a website assignment because it gives you clear users, a real-world problem, online functionality and opportunities for future growth.

The central problem is:

Customers do not always have enough time, facilities or energy to manage their laundry.

The business solution is:

FreshFold Laundry provides convenient washing, drying, folding, ironing and collection/delivery services that save customers time and effort.

8. Budget

Estimated Upper Life Apparel Website Budget

Cost Item	Estimated Cost
Website planning & requirements	R2,500
UI/UX design and wireframes	R4,000
Website development	R15,000

Cost Item	Estimated Cost
E-commerce/shop functionality	R8,000
Shopping cart & checkout	R4,000
Payment gateway integration	R2,500
Customer accounts & reviews	R2,500
Product/content setup	R3,000
Testing & mobile optimisation	R2,500
Domain (.co.za) – first year	R150
Hosting – first year	R3,600
SSL/security	R0
Initial SEO setup	R2,000

Estimated development + first-year setup R49,750

A **R50,000 budget** is therefore a realistic figure for the first year of a professionally developed Upper Life Apparel e-commerce website. This is within current South African market ranges for e-commerce websites, although a simpler template-based store could be considerably cheaper.

Reference List

Google Search Central (2026) *SEO best practices for ecommerce sites*. Available at: <https://developers.google.cn/search/docs/specialty/ecommerce> (Accessed: 1 September 2026).

Groundwork Digital (2026) *How much does a website cost for a small business in South Africa?* Available at: <https://www.groundworkdigital-za.co.za/blog/how-much-does-website-cost-south-africa> (Accessed: 1 September 2026).

Intellium Inc. (2026) *What does an ecommerce website cost in South Africa? 2026 price guide*. Available at: <https://intelliuminc.co.za/blogs/ecommerce-website-cost-south-africa/> (Accessed: 1 September 2026).

Nielsen Norman Group (2026) *UX and usability articles*. Available at: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/> (Accessed: 1 September 2026).

New Perspective Studio (2026) *What does website design cost in South Africa? 2026*. Available at: <https://www.newperspectivestudio.co.za/wp/what-is-the-cost-of-creating-a-website-in-south-africa> (Accessed: 1 September 2026).

Vision BI (2026) *How much does a website cost in South Africa in 2026?* Available at: <https://www.visionbi.co.za/blog/website-cost-south-africa-2026/> (Accessed: 1 September 2026).